Rose’s stomach clenched into a hard knot of fear.

“Come on, Rose,” Léa urged. “We’ll be quick.”

“Get on, then,” the man snapped, his voice sharp and impatient.

Rose’s uneasiness surged and the anxiety that had simmered all day and night now crashed to the surface. Hands shaking, she grabbed the other wheelbarrow and followed Léa.

“We’ll load up the wheelbarrows with all the crates because I don’t think he’ll wait for another trip,” Léa said.

Rose tried to keep pace with her sister, but she struggled, exhausted and out of breath. She’d stayed up late the night before, helping Léa load the crates into the rail carts. The church bell rang the half hour. Rose saw Léa already at the jetty unloading the demijohns onto the boat. She tried to pick up her speed but she worried that the demijohns would tumble out. Suddenly, the smuggler ran toward her.

“I’ve got this,” he said, gripping the wheelbarrow, pushing her aside. Rose followed. She saw the plank of wood he’d placed between the boat and the shore. He didn’t bother to stop and unload the crates; instead, he rolled the wheelbarrow across the plank and onto the boat.

“You ladies better go hide—now, now,” he said, untying the ropes and casting off.

A rattling noise in the distance made the sisters turn. Headlights flashed in the darkness. Rose’s knees began to shake. She felt Léa drop something into her pocket. “Run to the tunnel,” her sister whispered urgently.

Rose stared into the darkness, as if she was in the tunnel and the walls were closing in, clawing at her throat, freezing her in place.

“Run. You’ve got the key to the hatch in your pocket. To the tunnel now.”

The car was getting closer. She heard the gravel crunching under the tires.

“Close the hatch. Lock it with the key. They won’t find you. Get to the farmhouse.” She pushed her along. “Think of Virginie and Paulette.”

“Come with me,” Rose pleaded.

“Go now, before they get closer.”

The car headlights beamed brighter, making Rose’s heart thump.

“Trust me.” Léa pushed Rose so hard she nearly fell. “Run.”

Suddenly, the fear that had frozen her limbs shifted into panic. She ran.